

AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. — Code of Conduct Policy

Section 1: Purpose / Definition

AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. (hereinafter called "AstraNova" or "the Company") wants to keep a safe, friendly, and honest workplace. The Code of Conduct Policy sets the main rules for how we behave every day. This policy helps us respect each other, protect company work, and act fairly with our team and clients.

Section 2: Scope

This policy applies to all permanent employees, interns, and contract workers at AstraNova. It covers all behavior inside the physical Pune office, on corporate Slack and email channels, during online video calls, and at any company events outside the office.

Section 3: Eligibility

Every person working for AstraNova must follow these rules from their very first day of work. There is no minimum service time required. Following the Code of Conduct is a vital part of your employment contract.

Section 4: Rules & Guidelines

4.1 Respect and Inclusion

We believe in treating every single colleague with equal respect. AstraNova has a zero-tolerance rule for bullying, rude behavior, insulting comments, or discrimination of any kind. This includes comments about a person's race, religion, gender, age, or background. We expect everyone to speak and write in a professional and helpful way.

4.2 Honesty and Conflicts of Interest

Employees must always act in the best interest of AstraNova. You must not take on external jobs or freelance projects that compete with the Company. Working a second job in the tech field, also known as moonlighting, is strictly banned. If a family member works for a vendor or client that deals with AstraNova, you must tell HR right away.

4.3 Gifts and Bribery

You must not accept expensive gifts, free trips, or cash from any clients or suppliers who want to do business with AstraNova. Employees can only accept small items like

corporate pens or diaries worth less than INR 2,000. Accepting anything above this amount without checking with HR is a major policy breach.

4.4 Social Media and Public Talk

Only chosen team leaders can speak to the news media or post official statements about AstraNova's work and tools. Do not share raw project code, client data, or internal office problems on your personal social media accounts like LinkedIn or X (formerly Twitter).

Section 5: Process / Workflow

If you see someone breaking the Code of Conduct, follow these steps to report the issue:

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graph TD; A[Employee reports the issue to their Manager or fills out the HR portal form] --> B[HR team reviews the report and starts a private check within 48 hours]; B --> C[HR talks to the witness and collects emails or chat messages as proof]; C --> D[HR writes a final report and shares it with the Department Head]; D --> E[The Company takes action, which can include a warning or losing the job];
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HR writes a final report and shares it with the Department Head

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The Company takes action, which can include a warning or losing the job

Section 6: Roles & Responsibilities

6.1 Employee

- Follow all conduct rules every day and treat others with kindness.
- Report any rule breaks or bad behavior right away.
- Tell HR about any personal business choices that might conflict with your work.

6.2 Reporting Manager

- Lead by example and keep the team atmosphere friendly and fair.
- Never ignore bad behavior or complaints from your team members.
- Send complex issues or fights to the HR team immediately.

6.3 HR & Leadership Team

- Keep all reports strictly private to protect the person who shared the issue.
- Check every case fairly without taking sides.
- Apply the same rules and punishments to everyone, no matter their job rank.

Section 7: Exceptions

There are no major exceptions to the Code of Conduct. The core rules of honesty and respect must always be followed. Small choices, like speaking at a university event or accepting an award, must be approved in writing by your Department Head before the event occurs.

Section 8: Examples

- **Scenario A (Reporting Moonlighting):** A developer discovers that a teammate is spending their evening shift writing code for another startup company. The developer knows this violates the moonlighting rule, so they share the information with HR. HR checks the case and takes proper action to protect company code.
- **Scenario B (Handling Customer Gifts):** A customer sends a high-end smartphone worth INR 40,000 to a project lead as a thank-you gift. The lead knows this is way above the INR 2,000 limit. They do not open the package, they notify HR immediately, and they send the item back to the customer with a polite note explaining company rules.

Section 9: Important Notes

- **Avoid:** Do not use office Slack groups to start arguments about politics or religion. Keep all office chats focused on project tasks and general team building.
- **Best Practice:** If you are unsure whether a choice or action violates the policy, always send a quick email to your manager or HR to ask for guidance before you move forward.

Section 10: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1: Can I work on a personal tech project during my weekends?

A1: You can work on personal hobbies, but you must not build tools for other tech companies or take paid freelance jobs that conflict with AstraNova.

Q2: What should I do if a coworker sends me an offensive message on Slack?

A2: Take a clear screenshot of the message and report it to your direct manager or the HR team right away so they can fix the issue.

Q3: Is it okay to post about my daily tasks or share code snippets on LinkedIn?

A3: No. Sharing internal project code, client details, or secret project info on public platforms is strictly banned.

Q4: Can I accept a lunch invitation from a vendor who works with AstraNova?

A4: Yes, a standard working lunch is fine, but you must not let the vendor pay for expensive personal travel or costly entertainment.

Q5: What is the highest value allowed for a gift from a client?

A5: You can only accept small promotional gifts worth less than INR 2,000, like corporate pens, calendars, or notebook sets.

Q6: Can I recommend a family member for an open job role at AstraNova?

A6: Yes, you can refer them through the official system, but you must not be part of their interview loop or act as their direct manager.

Q7: Will my name be kept secret if I report a teammate for breaking the rules?

A7: Yes. AstraNova keeps all whistleblower profiles and report details private to ensure you feel safe sharing the issue.

Q8: What happens if an employee gets caught bullying a junior team member?

A8: The Company will start an official check. If true, the employee will face disciplinary action, which can lead to immediate termination.

Q9: Do these conduct rules apply when I am working from home?

A9: Yes. The same rules for professional speech, respect, and data safety apply exactly the same way when you work remotely.

Q10: Who handles final arguments if a manager and an employee have a major conflict?

A10: The HR team will act as an independent party to review the facts, talk to both sides, and find a fair solution based on company policies.